

TTS NEXT BPAs Support Area 5

RFQ Instructions & Evaluation Process

1.0 Overview

This NEXT BPA RFQ Instructions & Evaluation Process document is specific to Support Area 5 - Artificial Intelligence Strategy & Implementation. This Support Area is being conducted as full and open competition to GSA Multiple Award Schedule (MAS) contractors with at least one of the following Special Item Numbers and will use the ordering procedures under GSAR 538.71 - Federal Supply Schedule Ordering Procedures:

- 54151S
- 54151HACS
- 541519CSP
- 518210C

In accordance with GSAR 538.7102-2(c)(1), the Government intends to reserve at least one award under this Support Area for a small business MAS contractor.

General Information	
Contract Vehicle	GSA MAS with at least one of the following SINS: 54151S, 54151HACS, 541519CSP, 518210C
Set Aside	None
Single-Award or Multiple-Award BPA	Multiple-Award
Period of Performance (PoP)	5-Year Ordering Period
NAICS Code	541519 Other Computer Related Services
Size Standard	\$34.0M
FSC/PCS Product Code	DA01

Important Dates, Times, and Posting, Submission Information	
Questions Due Date	05/11/2026 at 4:00PM EST

How to Submit Questions	Email to the CO and CS following the email subject instructions in section 2.1 below.
Posting Location for Answers	GSA eBuy
RFQ Posting Location	GSA eBuy
Phase 1 RFQ Closing Date	05/29/2026 at 4:00PM EST

2.0 Instructions

2.1 Quote Instructions

Quote submissions must be submitted via GSA eBuy **under RFQ1809121** by the RFQ Closing Date listed above. Questions must be submitted to the Contracting Officer (CO) (jacqueline.mcglone@gsa.gov) and Contract Specialist (CS) (krystal.zoufaly@gsa.gov) via email. All email correspondence pertaining to this Support Area (SA) must use the email subject heading “NEXT BPA SA5- [Quoter’s Name]”.

The Government intends to award a multiple-award BPA under the quoter’s MAS contract based on initial quotations. The Government anticipates that approximately five BPA awards will be made; however, the Government reserves the right to make the number of awards that are in its best interest. Additionally, in accordance with GSAR 538.7102-2(c)(1), the Government intends to reserve at least one award for a small business MAS contractor. It is critical your initial submission is for your best quotation and that you are fully responsive to the RFQ.

In an effort to save both the Government and quoters time and resources, the Government will utilize a phased quote submission and evaluation approach. Quotes will be evaluated on the factors listed in Section 3.0 below. Failure to follow the instructions may result in the quote being removed from further consideration for award.

Quoters are cautioned not to include assumptions, caveats, or exceptions within any part of their submission. Inclusion of assumptions, caveats, or exceptions to the requirement of any kind may result in the quote no longer being considered. Quoters should **ONLY** submit information explicitly requested in this RFQ. Late quote submissions may not be considered.

2.2 List of Attachments

Support Area 5 Attachments:

- Attachment E - SA5 Quoter Price Sheet

2.3 Quote Contents for Phase 1

Cover Letter

The quote submission for Phase 1 must include a Cover Letter including, but not limited to, the following information:

- Date of Submission
- Quoter's Name, Address, CAGE, and Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)
- Quoter's Point of Contact Information (Name, Email Address, & Phone Number)
- Solicitation Title
- Phase Number
- GSA MAS Contract Number
- Introduction of quoter's team (including a prime/subcontractor arrangement, if applicable)

The cover letter is limited to one page, using a minimum font size of 11 points and one-inch margins.

MAS Performance Period

The quoter's MAS contract must have a performance period that extends beyond the anticipated performance period of the BPA. As such, the quoter's MAS contract expiration date, if all available MAS contract option periods are exercised, must extend into the end of Fiscal Year 2031 (FY 31) including all future MAS contract option periods. Quoters must confirm their MAS performance period in their Phase 1 quote submission.

Technical Factor 1 - Technical Capability

The quoter must provide a written response to the following question:

1. Describe your approach to implementing Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning (AI/ML) capabilities within a Federal, state or local government, or commercial (preferred) environment, including how you address model governance, explainability, bias detection, and ongoing performance monitoring. How do you evaluate when AI is the appropriate solution versus when traditional approaches are more effective? Include how you handle data quality, privacy constraints, and alignment with federal AI guidance (e.g., OMB M-25-21, M-25-22, M-26-04, the NIST AI Risk Management Framework).

The Factor 1 submission is limited to no more than two pages, using a minimum font size of 11 points and one-inch margins, and may not include links to external documents or websites.

Technical Factor 2 - Prior Technical Experience

The quoter must provide a written response to the following:

1. Provide a recent prior experience example of AI/ML implementations you have delivered, preferably in the public sector (Federal, state, or local government). An example from the

commercial sector is also allowed. Describe the problem being solved, the approach taken (including model selection and validation), how you managed risk and stakeholder trust, and any measurable impact. If the work involved sensitive data or required an Authorization to Operate (ATO), describe how AI components were integrated into the security and compliance process.

Prior experience is considered recent if the period of performance is within the last three years of the solicitation date for this BPA, or currently ongoing with at least one year of the project completed. The prior technical experience example must be from **a project where the quoter for this BPA was the prime contractor or the subcontractor where they performed the majority of the project scope**. The Government will not review any additional prior technical experiences submitted in excess of the stated limitation.

The Factor 2 submission is limited to no more than two pages, using a minimum font size of 11 points and one-inch margins.

Supplementary Technical Artifacts

For Factor 2, quoters may include attached artifacts or direct links to specific, bounded technical items (e.g., a single architecture diagram, a specific code file or line range, a pipeline configuration) illustrating the concept documented in the response.

Requirements:

- Must be explicitly referenced in the narrative with a clear explanation of relevance
- Must be specific and bounded (e.g., "Figure 1: Network segmentation diagram" or "github.com/repo/module.tf, lines 40-112")
- Must directly illustrate a claim in the response with additional technical detail
- Must represent real implementations (may be anonymized)

Not permitted:

- General websites, capability pages, marketing materials, slide decks, or brochures
- Broad repository links without specific file/section references
- Artifacts not explicitly referenced in the narrative
- Hypothetical, notional, or example configurations not derived from actual implementations

The written response must stand on its own; artifacts serve only to provide additional context or clarity.

Example: A response describing how container image scanning is enforced as a gate in CI/CD might reference:

"See Artifact A: CI pipeline configuration (.gitlab-ci.yml, lines 45-62) showing the container scan stage configured to fail the build on HIGH/CRITICAL findings before image promotion to the registry."

Inappropriate artifacts for this same claim would include: a slide deck on container security best practices, a vendor white paper on shift-left scanning, a report showing container scan findings, or a link to general scanning tool documentation.

2.4 Quote Contents for Phase 2 (if proceeding; see Section 3.2)

Cover Letter

The quote submission for Phase 2 must include a Cover Letter including, but not limited to, the following information:

- Date of Submission
- Quoter's Name, Address, CAGE, and Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)
- Quoter's Point of Contact Information (Name, Email Address, & Phone Number)
- Solicitation Title
- Phase Number
- GSA MAS Contract Number

The cover letter is limited to one page, using a minimum font size of 11 points and one-inch margins.

Representations to Provisions

The quoter must provide their representations to the provisions listed in Section 4.0 below, specifically the fill-in for FAR 52.209-7 Information Regarding Responsibility Matters, in their Phase 2 quote submission. In lieu of submitting the full text of those provisions, the quoter may identify the provision by paragraph identifier and provide the appropriate information with their quote if the representations have not already been made in their System for Award Management (SAM) record.

Technical Factor 3 - Oral Presentation

Technical Factor 3 will consist of an oral presentation to the Government on a date to be determined after the completion of Phase 1. The quoter will provide an oral presentation addressing at least the following:

- Demonstrate **or walkthrough** a working AI/ML capability and **walk-through** the full development lifecycle: problem framing, data preparation, model selection, validation, deployment, and ongoing monitoring. The demonstration **or walkthrough** should make clear what the model does, what it does not do, and where human decision-making

remains in the loop. Offerors who are unable to provide a live demonstration due to the sensitivity of the operating environment should provide a sufficiently detailed walkthrough of the capability, including architecture, methodology, and outcomes, to allow the evaluation team to assess technical depth and maturity equivalent to what a live demonstration would provide.

- Explain how you define the mission job or workflow to be improved, identify the user need and constraints, and determine whether AI is the appropriate solution or whether a non-AI approach would be more effective.
- Discuss how you assess whether a use case is ready for testing or deployment, including data availability and permissions, approved tools and access paths, accountable ownership, governance path, technical support, training, telemetry, and operational readiness.
- Explain how you conduct bounded pilots and experiments, including how you define success criteria, workflow scope, evaluation metrics, and the evidence needed to support a decision to refine, scale, or stop the use case.
- Explain your model governance framework, including how you document model decisions, track model drift, manage retraining cycles, and maintain audit trails sufficient for federal oversight and accountability requirements.
- Present your approach to AI risk management aligned with the NIST AI RMF, including how you categorize and mitigate risks related to bias, hallucination, data poisoning, and adversarial manipulation.
- Discuss how you secure AI systems and protect Government data inputs and outputs, including access control, logging, monitoring, and incident response.
- Explain how you design AI solutions to support interoperability, portability, and transition, including the use of open standards, standard APIs, and exportable formats.
- Describe how you avoid unnecessary vendor lock-in and preserve Government control over data, custom development, workflows, and integrations.
- Discuss how you manage model and service changes over time, including version updates, performance regressions, bias changes, and operational impacts.
- Explain how you support human oversight, traceability, source attribution, and auditable operation of AI-enabled systems.
- Articulate how you determine whether AI is the appropriate solution for a given problem, including examples of engagements where you recommended against an AI approach and what alternative they proposed instead.
- Discuss how AI components are integrated into the ATO process, including how you document AI-specific risks in system security plans, how you address data provenance and privacy (particularly under federal records and PII requirements), and how you handle continuous monitoring of AI systems post-authorization.
- Describe your staffing model for AI engagements, including how you balance data scientists, ML engineers, and domain subject matter experts, and how you approach knowledge transfer so the Government is not dependent on the vendor for ongoing model management.

The Government evaluation team may ask on-the-spot questions and/or a scenario during the presentation to further understand the quoter's technical understanding, capabilities, and situational response and assess their technical depth, operational maturity, and risk-based decision-making.

Oral Presentation Guidance:

- The meeting will be held virtually using Google Meet. Oral presentations may be recorded.
- The CO or CS will send a calendar invite for an agreed upon date with the meeting link.
- The session is expected to last approximately 60 minutes, including time for Q&A and discussion.
- The contractor should prepare a slide presentation and any other means of presenting the required information above.
- Further Oral Presentation guidance may be provided by the Government during the Oral Presentation scheduling process.

Factor 4 - Price

The quoter must use the template provided in Attachment E - Quoter Price Sheet to provide quoted hourly rates for the Government-established BPA Labor Categories (LCATs) by completing cells not already filled in by the Government. The quoter must map the quoted BPA LCATs to their equivalent or similar GSA MAS LCATs. In accordance with the Administration's cost saving initiatives to reduce Government spending, the Government encourages discounts to be applied to the quoted hourly rates. The discounts, however, should not compromise quality of service.

3.0 Evaluation

3.1 Basis for Award

The Government anticipates awarding a multiple-award BPA to the quoter(s) whose quote(s) represents the best value to the Government, price and technical factors considered, after the completion of Phases 1 and 2. To help select the best value quoters, the Government will utilize the Rates Only Price Evaluations (ROPE) with Best Value Trade Off methodologies.

Phase 1 is more important than Phase 2. The technical factors are listed in descending order of importance with Factor 1 being more important than Factor 2 and Factor 2 being more important than Factor 3. Each technical factor will receive an **individual** confidence rating, detailed below. **The technical factors will also receive an overall confidence rating.** Combined ratings from both phases will be considered in the award decision. The technical factors, when combined, are significantly more important than price.

Ratings assigned to the Phase 1 technical factors will not be revised following the completion of Phase 1.

3.2 Phasing and Advisory Down Select

After Phase 1 evaluations are complete, the CO or CS will email each quoter with an advisory notice. The notice will inform whether the quote is:

- Among the highest-rated and recommended to move on to Phase 2, or
- Not among the highest-rated and not recommended to move forward

The Government plans to invite the highest-rated quoters to continue to Phase 2. Even if quoters are not recommended to proceed, they may still choose to participate in Phase 2.

If a quoter chooses to move forward, they must email the CO and CS by the deadline listed in the advisory notice to confirm their intent to participate. Only quoters who confirm by the deadline will receive Phase 2 instructions.

To be considered for award of a Blanket Purchase Agreement (BPA), quoters must participate in all phases of the process. Therefore, quoters who do not submit a quote in Phase 1 cannot continue to later phases.

3.3 Phase 1 Evaluation Factors

Cover Letter

The Government will confirm whether quoters submitted a Cover Letter for Phase 1 and in accordance with the requirements of Section 2.3 above.

MAS Performance Period

The Government will reject the quote if the quoter's MAS contract expiration date does not extend into the end of FY 31 including all future MAS contract option periods.

Factor 1 - Technical Capability and Factor 2 - Prior Technical Experience

The following confidence ratings will be used to evaluate Phase 1 Factors 1 and 2:

High Confidence	The Government has high confidence that the quoter understands the requirement, provides a sound approach, and will be successful in performing the BPA call orders with little or no Government intervention.
Some Confidence	The Government has some confidence that the quoter understands the requirement, provides a sound approach, and will be successful in performing the BPA

	call orders with some Government intervention.
Low Confidence	The Government has low confidence that the quoter understands the requirement, provides a sound approach, or will be successful in performing the BPA call orders even with Government intervention.

3.4 Phase 2 Evaluation Factors

Cover Letter

For quotes participating in Phase 2, the Government will confirm whether quoters submitted a Cover Letter and in accordance with the requirements of Section 2.4 above.

Representations to Provisions

For quoters participating in Phase 2, the Government will review the quoter's representations to the required provisions.

Factor 3 - Oral Presentation

Phase 2 quotes will be evaluated using confidence ratings for Factor 3. The same confidence ratings in Section 3.3 above will be used for Factor 3 **and the overall technical factors confidence rating.**

Factor 4 - Price

An overall price reasonableness determination will be made for Factor 4. The Government will use the Rates Only for Pricing Evaluations methodology to evaluate price for this effort. The Government will apply the quoter's hourly rates from the Attachment E - SA5 Quoter Price Sheet to an estimated number of hours for each labor category to arrive at a Total Evaluated Price. The Total Evaluated Price will be used in the best-value analysis. The Government will not disclose the estimated number of hours being used in the analysis to quoters.

Quoted labor rates may not exceed the quoter's established GSA MAS rates. Accordingly, the overall price reasonableness evaluation will also be used to establish the maximum LCAT rates for the awarded BPAs and subsequent call orders.

The Government may waive informalities and minor irregularities in quotes received.

3.5 Tradeoff and Best-Suited Quoter Selection

After the completion of the Phase 2 evaluation, the Government will perform a tradeoff analysis between all of the non-price factors combined and price to determine which quoter(s) represents the best value to the Government. These quoter(s) will be considered the apparent best-suited

quoter(s). Price may become a more decisive factor when competing quotes demonstrate comparable technical ratings. The Government anticipates selecting the best-suited quoter(s) from initial responses, without engaging in exchanges with quoters.

3.6 Post-Tradeoff Review and Negotiation

Once the Government determines the apparent best-suited quoter(s) in accordance with Section 3.5, the Government reserves the right to communicate and negotiate with only those quoter(s) to address any remaining issues, if necessary, and finalize a BPA award with those quoter(s). The issues to be negotiated may consist of technical and/or price, including seeking further discounts in accordance with GSAR 538.7102-2(c)(2).

If the parties cannot successfully address any remaining issues and come to an agreement acceptable to the Government, the Government will rescind its selection and determine the next best-suited quoter(s) and may communicate and negotiate with only those quoter(s) based on the original analysis and address any remaining issues. The BPA will ultimately be awarded to the quoter(s) representing the best value to the Government. An award may be made to quoter(s) that is neither the lowest-priced nor the highest-rated technically but represents the best overall value to the Government. The Government may waive informalities and minor irregularities in quotes received.

4.0 Provisions & Clauses

Provisions

FAR 52.209-7 Information Regarding Responsibility Matters (NOV 2025)

(a) Definitions. As used in this provision —

Administrative proceeding means a non-judicial process that is adjudicatory in nature in order to make a determination of fault or liability (e.g., Securities and Exchange Commission Administrative Proceedings, Civilian Board of Contract Appeals Proceedings, and Armed Services Board of Contract Appeals Proceedings). This includes administrative proceedings at the Federal and State level but only in connection with performance of a Federal contract or grant. It does not include agency actions such as contract audits, site visits, corrective plans, or inspection of deliverables.

Federal contracts and grants with total value greater than \$10,000,000 means —

(1) The total value of all current, active contracts and grants, including all priced options;
and

(2) The total value of all current, active orders including all priced options under indefinite-delivery, indefinite-quantity, 8(a), or requirements contracts (including task and delivery and multiple-award Schedules).

Principal means an officer, director, owner, partner, or a person having primary management or supervisory responsibilities within a business entity (e.g., general manager; plant manager; head of a division or business segment; and similar positions).

(b) The offeror ☐ has ☐ does not have current active Federal contracts and grants with total value greater than \$10,000,000.

(c) If the offeror checked "has" in paragraph (b) of this provision, the offeror represents, by submission of this offer, that the information it has entered in the Federal Awardee Performance and Integrity Information System (FAPIS) is current, accurate, and complete as of the date of submission of this offer with regard to the following information:

(1) Whether the offeror, and/or any of its principals, has or has not, within the last five years, in connection with the award to or performance by the offeror of a Federal contract or grant, been the subject of a proceeding, at the Federal or State level that resulted in any of the following dispositions:

(i) In a criminal proceeding, a conviction.

(ii) In a civil proceeding, a finding of fault and liability that results in the payment of a monetary fine, penalty, reimbursement, restitution, or damages of \$5,000 or more.

(iii) In an administrative proceeding, a finding of fault and liability that results in—

(A) The payment of a monetary fine or penalty of \$5,000 or more; or

(B) The payment of a reimbursement, restitution, or damages in excess of \$100,000.

(iv) In a criminal, civil, or administrative proceeding, a disposition of the matter by consent or compromise with an acknowledgment of fault by the Contractor if the proceeding could have led to any of the outcomes specified in paragraphs (c)(1)(i), (c)(1)(ii), or (c)(1)(iii) of this provision.

(2) If the offeror has been involved in the last five years in any of the occurrences listed in (c)(1) of this provision, whether the offeror has provided the requested information with regard to each occurrence.

(d) The offeror shall post the information in paragraphs (c)(1)(i) through (c)(1)(iv) of this provision in FAPIIS as required through maintaining an active registration in the System for Award Management, which can be accessed via <https://www.sam.gov> (see 52.204-7).

(End of provision)

FAR 52.233-2 Service of Protest (NOV 2025)

(a) Protests, (as defined in FAR 33.102), that are filed directly with an agency, and copies of any protests that are filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), must be served on the Contracting Officer identified in the solicitation by obtaining written and dated acknowledgment of receipt from them.

(b) The copy of any protest must be received in the office designated above within one day of filing a protest with the GAO.

(End of provision)

FAR 52.252-1 Solicitation Provisions Incorporated by Reference (FEB 1998)

This solicitation incorporates one or more solicitation provisions by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. The offeror is cautioned that the listed provisions may include blocks that must be completed by the offeror and submitted with its quotation or offer. In lieu of submitting the full text of those provisions, the offeror may identify the provision by paragraph identifier and provide the appropriate information with its quotation or offer. Also, the full text of a solicitation provision may be accessed electronically at these addresses:

FAR: <https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul/far-part-deviation-guide/far-overhaul-part-52>

GSAR: <https://www.acquisition.gov/gsam/part-552>

Provision	Title
FAR 52.204-7	System for Award Management - Registration (NOV 2025)
FAR 52.217-5	Evaluation of Options (NOV 2025)
GSAR 552.217-71	Notice Regarding Option(s) (NOV 1992)
GSAR 552.252-5	Authorized Deviations in Provisions (NOV 2024)

(End of provision)

Clauses

All clauses from the quoter's MAS contract flow down to this solicitation and resulting multi-award BPA. As such, the clauses listed below are in addition to the clauses on the quoter's MAS contract.

FAR 52.217-8 Option to Extend Services (NOV 1999)

The Government may require continued performance of any services within the limits and at the rates specified in the contract. These rates may be adjusted only as a result of revisions to prevailing labor rates provided by the Secretary of Labor. The option provision may be exercised more than once, but the total extension of performance hereunder shall not exceed 6 months. The Contracting Officer may exercise the option by written notice to the Contractor within 60 days of contract expiration.

(End of clause)

FAR 52.217-9 Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (MAR 2000)

(a) The Government may extend the term of this contract by written notice to the Contractor within 30 days of contract expiration; provided that the Government gives the Contractor a preliminary written notice of its intent to extend at least 60 days before the contract expires. The preliminary notice does not commit the Government to an extension.

(b) If the Government exercises this option, the extended contract shall be considered to include this option clause.

(c) The total duration of this contract, including the exercise of any options under this clause, shall not exceed 5 years.

(End of clause)

FAR 52.222-90 Addressing DEI Discrimination by Federal Contractors (APR 2026)

(a) Definitions. As used in this clause —

Program participation means membership or participation in, or access or admission to: training, mentoring, or leadership development programs; educational opportunities; clubs; associations; or similar opportunities that are sponsored or established by the contractor or subcontractor.

Racially discriminatory diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) activities means disparate treatment based on race or ethnicity in the recruitment, employment (e.g., hiring, promotions), contracting

(e.g., vendor agreements), program participation, or allocation or deployment of an entity's resources.

(b) In connection with the performance of work under this contract, the Contractor agrees as follows:

- (1) The Contractor will not engage in any racially discriminatory DEI activities;
- (2) The Contractor will furnish all information and reports, including providing access to books, records, and accounts, as required by the Contracting Officer, for purposes of ascertaining compliance with this clause;
- (3) In the event of the Contractor's or a subcontractor's noncompliance with this clause, this contract may be canceled, terminated, or suspended in whole or in part, and the Contractor or subcontractor may be declared ineligible for further Government contracts;
- (4) The Contractor will report any subcontractor's known or reasonably knowable conduct that may violate this clause to the Contracting Officer and take any appropriate remedial actions directed by the Contracting Officer; and
- (5) The Contractor will inform the Contracting Officer if a subcontractor sues the Contractor and the suit puts at issue, in any way, the validity of this clause.
- (6) The Contractor recognizes that compliance with the requirements of this clause are material to the Government's payment decisions for purposes of 31 U.S.C. 3729(b)(4).

(c) The Contractor must include the substance of this clause, including this paragraph (c), in subcontracts at any tier, including those for commercial products and commercial services, except those where the place of delivery or performance is outside the United States.

(End of clause)

FAR 52.237-3 Continuity of Services (JAN 1991)

(a) The Contractor recognizes that the services under this contract are vital to the Government and must be continued without interruption and that, upon contract expiration, a successor, either the Government or another contractor, may continue them. The Contractor agrees to-

- (1) Furnish phase-in training; and
- (2) Exercise its best efforts and cooperation to effect an orderly and efficient transition to a successor.

(b) The Contractor shall, upon the Contracting Officer's written notice, (1) furnish phase-in, phase-out services for up to 90 days after this contract expires and (2) negotiate in good faith a plan with a successor to determine the nature and extent of phase-in, phase-out services required. The plan shall specify a training program and a date for transferring responsibilities for each division of work described in the plan, and shall be subject to the Contracting Officer's approval. The Contractor shall provide sufficient experienced personnel during the phase-in, phase-out period to ensure that the services called for by this contract are maintained at the required level of proficiency.

(c) The Contractor shall allow as many personnel as practicable to remain on the job to help the successor maintain the continuity and consistency of the services required by this contract. The Contractor also shall disclose necessary personnel records and allow the successor to conduct on-site interviews with these employees. If selected employees are agreeable to the change, the Contractor shall release them at a mutually agreeable date and negotiate transfer of their earned fringe benefits to the successor.

(d) The Contractor shall be reimbursed for all reasonable phase-in, phase-out costs (i.e., costs incurred within the agreed period after contract expiration that result from phase-in, phase-out operations) and a fee (profit) not to exceed a pro rata portion of the fee (profit) under this contract.

(End of clause)